

Forest flowers
provide nectar for
passing insects.

Shrubs

You'll see few flowers in a coniferous forest, but some shrubs, such as wild roses, can bloom beneath the needles. They are found in the north of the United States, northern Europe, and Asia.



Lichens

Open conifer forests are home to lichens. These spongelike growths are not plants, but are a partnership between an alga and a fungus. Reindeer lichen is a vital food for caribou in winter and can cover an entire forest floor.

Mosses

Mosses are simple plants known as bryophytes. They can't move water around their bodies, but instead soak it up like sponges. Like ferns, mosses produce no flowers. They release tiny spores to reproduce.

